STIVEN CATALYST

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MANAGEMENT REVIEW

Management without theatre.



ROLE

SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

How many people really know themselves, how others see us, Goleman's five components, what the research finds on emotional intelligence, and a self-awareness card.

10–15%

of the people studied by Tasha Eurich's team fit the criteria of self-awareness, by her estimate, though most believe they are self-aware.

EURICH, 2018

INSIDE

COVER STORY
10 to 15 out of 100
PAGE 03

THE MODEL
What makes a leader
PAGE 05

TOOL OF THE ISSUE
The self-awareness card
PAGE 08

NO. 31 · ROLE

In this issue

A manager watches the team every day, and the team watches the manager, often more clearly. What are self-awareness and emotional intelligence, what does the research actually show, and how do you learn how others see you?

In Tasha Eurich's research most people believed they were self-aware, but only 10–15% fit her criteria. Ratings of the same people by peers and by bosses agree at 0.62; a person's own rating agrees with either at about 0.35. Daniel Goleman's five components of emotional intelligence came with bold claims. Meta-analyses find moderate links with performance, and much of what self-reported emotional intelligence predicts was already covered by personality and ability measures.

Stiven Janaqi EDITOR · STIVEN CATALYST

03 COVER STORY
10 to 15 out of 100

04 THE NUMBERS
How others see us

05 THE MODEL
What makes a leader

06 WHAT THE RESEARCH SAYS
Two kinds of emotional intelligence

07 HOW IT IS MEASURED
Seeing yourself, being seen

08 TOOL OF THE ISSUE
The self-awareness card

09 SOURCES
Sources and method

HOW TO READ THIS ISSUE

Figure
Every figure has its source and year at the foot of its page.

Our reading
Where the editor interprets rather than the research, it says so.

Practice
The steps and the card are proposals to try, not research results.

COVER STORY

10 to 15 out of 100

Tasha Eurich's team ran ten investigations with nearly 5,000 participants and reviewed about 800 studies. Her conclusion in Harvard Business Review, 2018: most people believe they are self-aware, but only 10–15% of those studied fit the criteria.

10–15%
of the people studied fit the criteria of self-awareness, by Eurich's estimate

19 of 20
competencies in which higher-level leaders overrated themselves more than lower-level ones, in a study of over 3,600 leaders

Eurich explains it with experience and power: senior leaders have fewer people above them who give candid feedback, and the more power a leader holds, the less comfortable others feel offering criticism. The most effective leaders, she writes, counter this by seeking critical feedback often, from bosses, peers, staff and the board.

OUR READING

Rank brings more information about the business and less about yourself. Only deliberate effort closes that gap.

Source: Tasha Eurich, Harvard Business Review, 2018

The 10–15% is the author's estimate: she lists four criteria but shows no calculation, and the study of 3,600 leaders she cites is not named.

THE NUMBERS

How others see us

In 1988 Michael Harris and John Schaubroeck pooled studies of performance ratings. Peers and bosses agreed fairly well about the same people; the people's own ratings agreed far less with either.

AGREEMENT BETWEEN RATINGS OF THE SAME PEOPLE'S PERFORMANCE (CORRELATION)



LINK BETWEEN A LEADER'S EI AND TRANSFORMATIONAL LEADERSHIP, BY WHO RATES THEM



Peter Harms and Marcus Credé found the second pattern in a 2010 meta-analysis. Different raters also agreed little with each other: 0.14 on leadership and 0.16 on emotional intelligence.

Sources: Michael M. Harris & John Schaubroeck, Personnel Psychology, 1988 (via Abstract); Peter D. Harms & Marcus Credé, Journal of Leadership & Organizational Studies, 2010 (via Abstract)

These are correlations from meta-analyses and do not prove cause. The 1988 figures concern performance ratings in general, not emotional intelligence.

THE MODEL

What makes a leader

In 1998 Daniel Goleman described emotional intelligence at work in five components. Self-awareness comes first: knowing your emotions, strengths, weaknesses, drives and values, and their effect on others.

01	**Self-awareness**	Realistic self-assessment, humour about oneself, a thirst for constructive criticism.
02	**Self-regulation**	Managing disruptive emotions and impulses: thinking before acting.
03	**Motivation**	Passion for the work beyond money or status, and persistence.
04	**Empathy**	Understanding the emotional makeup of others and treating them accordingly.
05	**Social skill**	Managing relationships, building networks, finding common ground.

His basis: competency models from 188 companies, some built from senior managers' judgments, some from criteria such as division profits. He wrote that emotional intelligence was twice as important as technical skills and IQ for jobs at all levels, and that for senior leaders nearly 90% of the difference in their profiles came from it. The article does not show how these ratios were calculated.

OUR READING

The five components make a useful checklist. The ratios are a claim still waiting for evidence.

Source: Daniel Goleman, Harvard Business Review, 1998

HBR is a magazine for practitioners, and its articles are not peer-reviewed. The 90% refers to differences between competency profiles; it says nothing about how much of performance emotional intelligence explains.

More in the essay From Albania to Germany: what I have changed in the way I lead

WHAT THE RESEARCH SAYS

Two kinds of emotional intelligence

In 2010 Dana Joseph and Daniel Newman showed that the label covers two different things: ability EI, measured with tests that have right answers, and mixed EI, measured mostly with self-report questionnaires that also take in personality, motivation and other competencies.

Ernest O'Boyle and colleagues found that all three kinds of EI measure correlate with job performance, at 0.24 to 0.30 after correction. For ability EI, Joseph and Newman found the link inconsistent: positive in jobs with much emotional labour, negative in jobs with little.

SELF-REPORTED, MIXED EI AND JOB PERFORMANCE (JOSEPH ET AL., 2015)

01
0.47
the earlier estimate, from 2010

02
0.29
the updated estimate, with performance rated by supervisors

03
−0.02
after controlling for ability EI, self-efficacy, self-rated performance, personality and general mental ability

OUR READING

What self-report questionnaires predict, older measures mostly predicted already. What others can see a leader do is a better place to start.

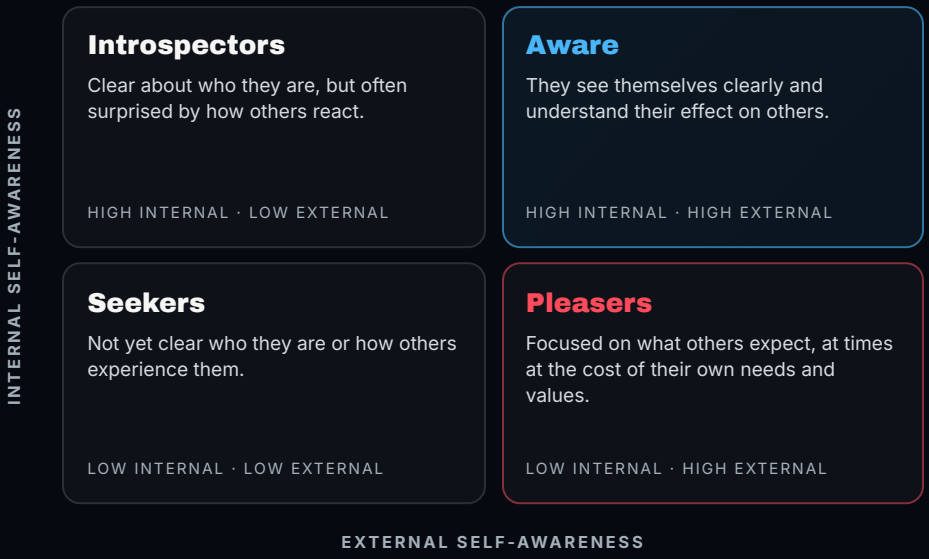
Sources: Dana L. Joseph & Daniel A. Newman, Journal of Applied Psychology, 2010 (via Abstract); Ernest H. O'Boyle Jr. et al., Journal of Organizational Behavior, 2011 (via Abstract); Dana L. Joseph, Jing Jin, Daniel A. Newman & Ernest H. O'Boyle, Journal of Applied Psychology, 2015 (via Abstract)

Correlations do not prove cause; 0.47 and 0.29 are correlations, −0.02 is a regression weight. The O'Boyle figures are from the article's abstract.

HOW IT IS MEASURED

Seeing yourself, being seen

Eurich separates internal self-awareness, how clearly we see our own values, reactions and impact, from external self-awareness, how well we understand how others see us. By her account the two are unrelated, which gives four types.



Measuring it means comparing a self-rating with other people's ratings. John Fleenor and colleagues reviewed the research on this self–other agreement: studies measure it in different ways, so their findings do not agree.

Sources: Tasha Eurich, Harvard Business Review, 2018; John W. Fleenor et al., The Leadership Quarterly, 2010 (via Abstract)

The four types are a description, with no measured split behind it: how many people fall into each is not given.

TOOL OF THE ISSUE

The self-awareness card

Answer the questions yourself, then put the same ones to three people who see your work: a boss, a peer and someone in your team. What matters are the gaps.

01 What I do well two or three things, in my words

02 What they say I do well the same question, in their words

03 What I could do better my view

04 What they say I could do better their view, without arguing back

05 Where we differ most one gap to look at

06 One thing to try what, from when, and when I ask again

Source: Tasha Eurich, Harvard Business Review, 2018

An exercise of our own, after Eurich (2018) on external self-awareness and critical feedback. It is not a test of emotional intelligence.

SOURCES AND METHOD

Every figure has a source.

The figures in this issue come from the sources below. The year shows how recent each one is.

What Self-Awareness Really Is (and How to Cultivate It)
Tasha Eurich, Harvard Business Review, 2018
https://hbr.org/2018/01/what-self-awareness-really-is-and-how-to-cultivate-it

A meta-analysis of self-supervisor, self-peer, and peer-supervisor ratings
Michael M. Harris & John Schaubroeck, Personnel Psychology, 1988 · via Abstract
https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.1988.tb00631.x

Emotional intelligence and transformational and transactional leadership: A meta-analysis
Peter D. Harms & Marcus Credé, Journal of Leadership & Organizational Studies, 2010 · via Abstract
https://doi.org/10.1177/1548051809350894

What Makes a Leader?
Daniel Goleman, Harvard Business Review, 1998
https://hbr.org/2004/01/what-makes-a-leader

Emotional intelligence: An integrative meta-analysis and cascading model
Dana L. Joseph & Daniel A. Newman, Journal of Applied Psychology, 2010 · via Abstract
https://doi.org/10.1037/a0017286

The relation between emotional intelligence and job performance: A meta-analysis
Ernest H. O'Boyle Jr. et al., Journal of Organizational Behavior, 2011 · via Abstract
https://doi.org/10.1002/job.714

Why does self-reported emotional intelligence predict job performance? A meta-analytic investigation of mixed EI
Dana L. Joseph, Jing Jin, Daniel A. Newman & Ernest H. O'Boyle, Journal of Applied Psychology, 2015 · via Abstract
https://doi.org/10.1037/a0037681

Self–other rating agreement in leadership: A review
John W. Fleenor et al., The Leadership Quarterly, 2010 · via Abstract
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.leaqua.2010.10.006

EDITORIAL METHOD

Each figure was checked for its year, its publisher and what it measures, in the full text where it could be opened. A source read only in a summary, an abstract or excerpts is marked “via”. A figure not confirmed in what was read is marked so on its page, or left out. The editor's interpretation is marked “Our reading”.



MANAGEMENT REVIEW

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Every issue, one management question, checked against the best research.

ALL ISSUES

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Edited by Stiven Janaqi, who answers for it; “the editors” in this publication means him. Its texts, translations, layout and the checking of figures against their sources are done in working sessions with Claude, an AI model by Anthropic.
stivencatalyst.com/how-this-is-made.html